

European Optical Market & Competitor Analysis

Market Intelligence working-student application

Focus: European ophthalmic spectacle lenses
Data cut: September 2026

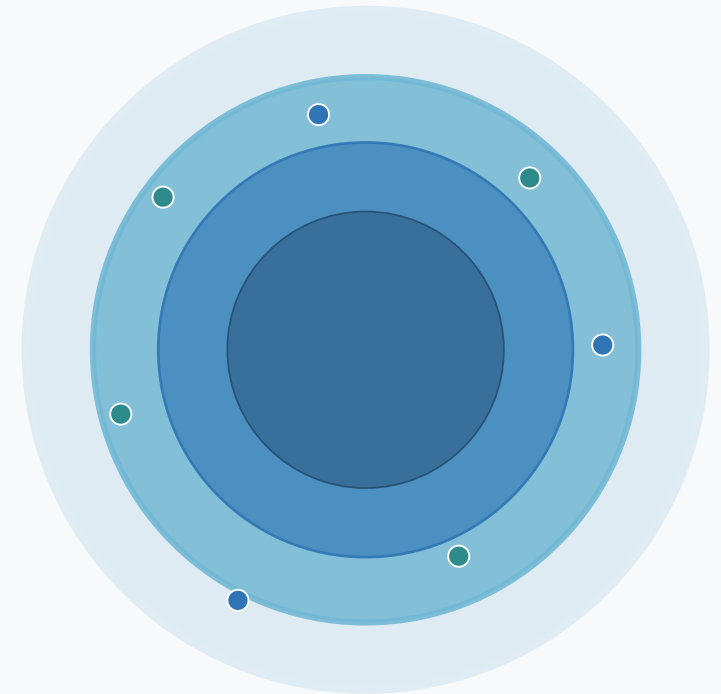
Market context

Germany deep dive

Competitor benchmark

Strategic implications

Public secondary research | Excel analysis | Portfolio presentation



Biometry • Myopia • Coatings • Channels

WHAT THE ANALYSIS FOUND

Executive summary

1

Value is more resilient than volume

Germany: 2022–2025 sector revenue +5.0%, while complete-spectacle volumes fell ~6.0% and spectacle-lens volumes ~5.6%.

2

Demographics support long-term relevance

22% of the EU population was aged 65+ in 2025, supporting continued relevance of presbyopia correction and premium progressives.

3

Personalisation is now a common theme

Rodenstock, Essilor, ZEISS and HOYA all use richer biometric, behavioural or wearer-specific inputs in premium lens design.

4

Myopia management is a distinct category

MyCon 2, Stellest, MyoCare and MiYOSMART show competition increasingly extending beyond standard vision correction.

5

Competitor channel models differ materially

EssilorLuxottica combines wholesale with a large proprietary retail and e-commerce footprint, while Rodenstock, ZEISS and HOYA are more strongly partner-led in their go-to-market models.

BOTTOM LINE

The strategic challenge is less about entering missing categories — and more about proving biometric value, defending myopia evidence and tailoring the channel proposition.

Scope and broader European market context

CORE ANALYSIS

European prescription spectacle lenses

- Single-vision
- Progressive
- Occupational / digital
- Photochromic
- Myopia-management lenses
- Premium coatings as value-add

Why this scope?

Frames, contact lenses and intraocular lenses have different demand drivers and competitive dynamics.

Broader ophthalmic-lens context*

2025 estimate

USD 5.4bn

2035 forecast

USD 8.5bn

2026–35 CAGR

4.6%

Scope note

GMI includes spectacle lenses, contact lenses and IOLs. These figures are used only as wider market context — not as a spectacle-lens TAM.

22%

of the EU population was aged 65+ in 2025

Demographic support for presbyopia correction and progressive lenses

Germany: value grows while physical volumes soften

Industry revenue, 2022–2025

+5.0%

EUR 6.688bn → EUR 7.025bn

Complete spectacles

–6.0%

12.52m → 11.77m

Spectacle lenses

–5.6%

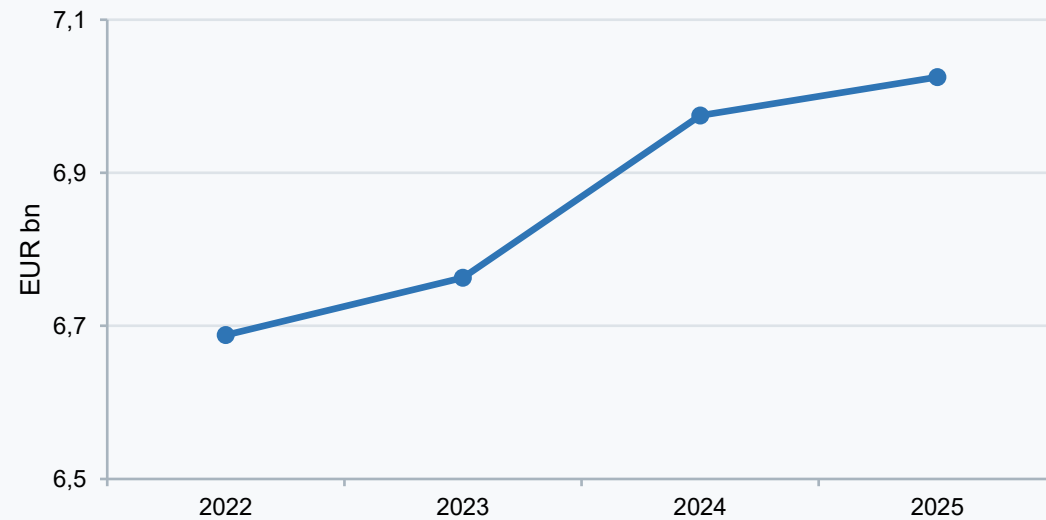
38.73m → 36.56m

Optical retail locations

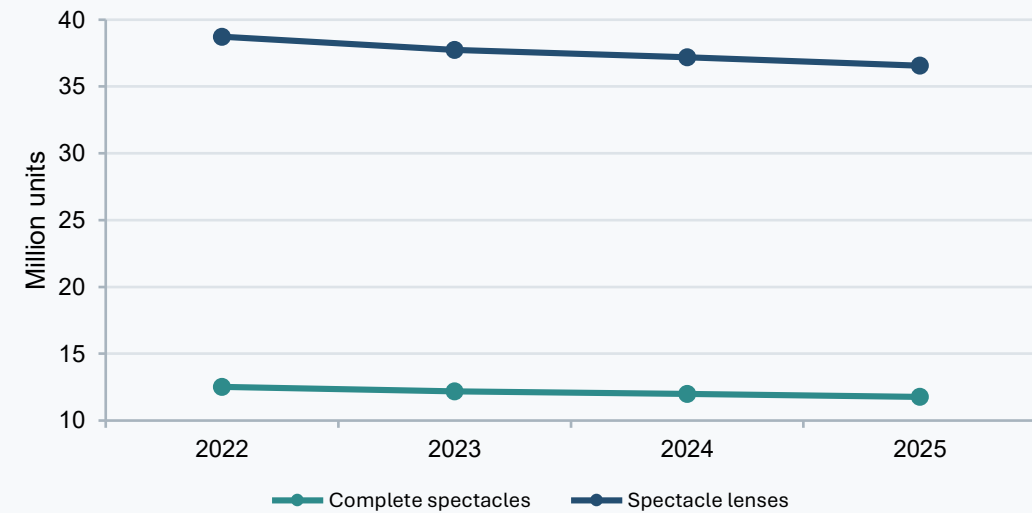
–3.6%

11,100 → 10,700

Industry revenue development



Unit sales development



Market structure: Top 10 companies = 55% of sector revenue • Online ≈ 5% • Value appears more resilient than unit growth

Source: ZVA Branchenbericht 2025/2026 and detailed ZVA market data.

Competitor benchmark: product and technology evidence

Personalisation is no longer unique as a category message. The meaningful difference is how each company creates and proves that personalisation.

Rodenstock

PERSONALISATION B.I.G. EXACT Sensitive

MYOPIA MyCon 2

COATING Solitaire LayR

APPROACH Biometric individualisation

Distinctive story: precise biometric eye model + visual sensitivity + DNEye measurement.

Essilor / EssilorLuxottica

PERSONALISATION Varilux XR series

MYOPIA Stellest

COATING Crizal Sapphire HR

APPROACH AI-supported progressive design

Distinctive story: broad lens ecosystem paired with large retail and distribution reach.

ZEISS Vision Care

PERSONALISATION ClearMind Individual 3

MYOPIA MyoCare

COATING DuraVision Plus Gold UV

APPROACH Anatomy + behaviour-based

Distinctive story: premium optics, anatomy/behaviour individualisation and coating technology.

HOYA Vision Care

PERSONALISATION Hoyalux iD MySense

MYOPIA MiYOSMART

COATING Hi-Vision Meiryo

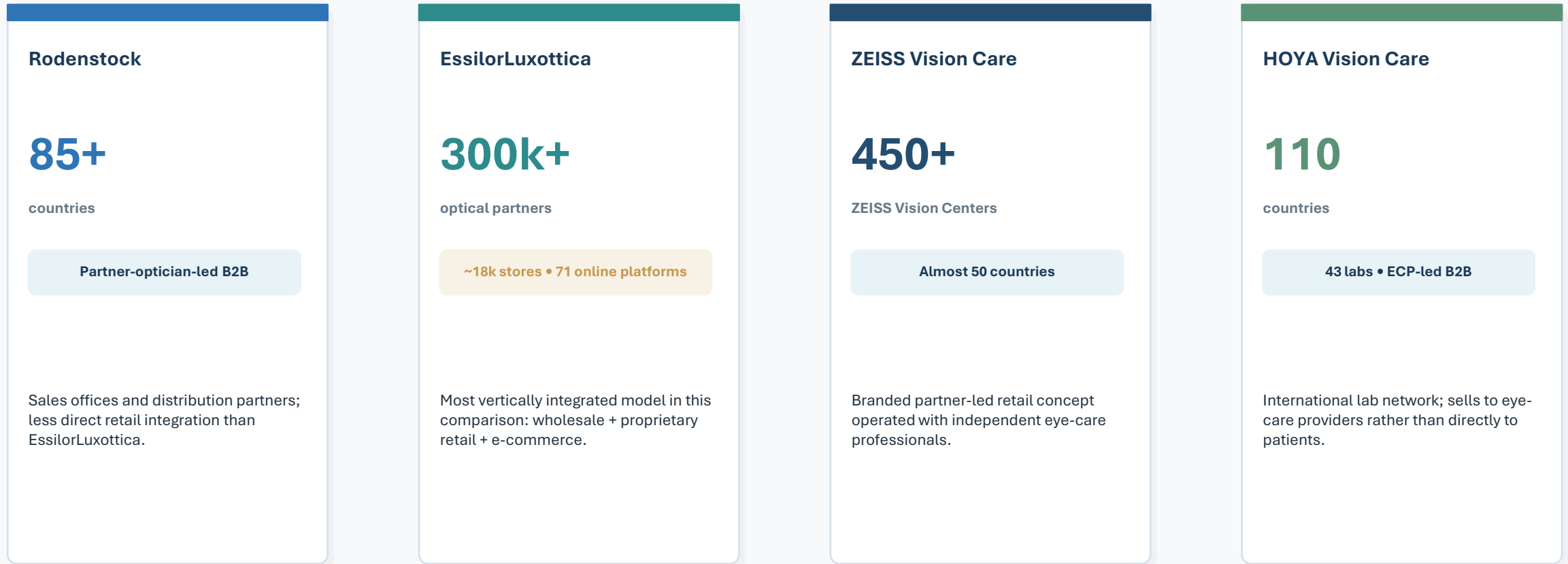
APPROACH Visual Sensory Intelligence

Distinctive story: personalised progressives plus strong visibility in myopia management.

Sources: official Rodenstock, Essilor, ZEISS and HOYA product pages (see report/source list).

Channel model / reach: different routes to market

Public channel disclosures use different units (countries, partners, stores, labs). The useful comparison is the go-to-market model rather than a single scale ranking.



Sources: company annual/corporate disclosures — Rodenstock (85+ countries); EssilorLuxottica 2025 Annual Report; ZEISS Vision Center materials; HOYA Vision Care FAQ.

Market trends → Rodenstock position → implication

Trend	Rodenstock today	Gap / opportunity	Strategic implication
Ageing / presbyopia	Strong progressive portfolio	Demographics (22% of the EU population was aged 65+ in 2025) support long-term category relevance	Expand premium progressive value through comfort, adaptation and measurable wearer benefits
Myopia management	MyCon 2	Strong competing platforms: Stellest, MiYOSMART, MyoCare	Strengthen clinical evidence, optician education and communication around MyCon 2
Personalisation	B.I.G. EXACT + biometric positioning	Personalisation is common competitor language	Differentiate biometric depth and prove wearer outcomes
Premium coatings	Solitaire LayR	All major competitors offer premium coatings	Use coating as part of a broader premium proposition
Channel structure	Partner-optician model	Large accounts matter; online remains secondary in Germany	Tailor B2B proposition by account type and support the in-store journey

Sources: Eurostat; ZVA; official Rodenstock, Essilor, ZEISS and HOYA product/corporate sources; selected scientific literature.

Four strategic priorities emerging from the case

1

Prove biometric value

Personalisation is now common competitor language. Rodenstock's advantage is the depth of biometric measurement — so the proof should focus on wearer outcomes, not just the word “personalised”.

2

Strengthen MyCon 2 evidence & education

The category is crowded with Stelless, MiYOSMART and MyoCare. Competitive defence should combine clinical evidence, optician education and clear parent-facing communication.

3

Package coatings into a broader premium proposition

Premium coatings are available across all major competitors. The stronger story is the combined wearer benefit of lens design + coating rather than a stand-alone coating claim.

4

Tailor the proposition by channel

Large accounts represent a substantial share of German optical revenue, while professional consultation remains central. Key accounts and independent premium opticians need different support.

Cross-cutting Market Intelligence need: continuously monitor competitor evidence, channel shifts and wearer/customer outcomes.

Selected sources and research notes

Market & demographics

- Global Market Insights — Europe Ophthalmic Lenses Market
- Eurostat — Demography of Europe 2026
- ZVA — Branchenbericht 2025/2026

Rodenstock

- B.I.G. VISION / B.I.G. EXACT Sensitive
- Children's lenses / MyCon 2
- Lens portfolio / Solitaire LayR
- Company / channel footprint

Competitors

- Essilor: Varilux XR, Stellest, Crizal Sapphire HR
- EssilorLuxottica 2025 Annual Report
- ZEISS: ClearMind, MyoCare, DuraVision, Vision Center
- HOYA: Hoyalux iD MySense, MiYOSMART, Meiryo, channel FAQ

Scientific context

- PubMed — European myopia meta-analysis (2025)

Limitations

Public market-size definitions vary; product pages are marketing sources; European countries differ in reimbursement and retail structure; a real company project would validate findings with internal sales data, customer research and paid databases.

What this portfolio case demonstrates



Skills demonstrated

Secondary research & source evaluation

Excel trend analysis and data visualisation

Competitor & product benchmarking

Channel-model analysis

Strategic synthesis and presentation storytelling

Methodological discipline

- Broader GMI market estimate kept separate from spectacle-lens TAM
- Germany treated as a transparent deep dive — not a proxy for all Europe
- Product claims compared descriptively because test methods differ
- Channel metrics not reduced to an artificial numeric ranking